

Validation Object Relationship Module (VORM)

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture

Parent Standard: Validation Object Standard (VOBS)

Operational Layer: Validation Object Governance Layer

Category: AI & Interpretation

Subcategory: Validation Governance

Type: Parent Standard Module

Governed Space: Validation Object Relationship

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Status: Canonical · Open Module

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Compatibility: OOF® Methodology OS™ · GOA™ · OBIDENITY® · INTEGROS®
· ORA™ · AGA™ · AIG® · CLIA® · MGIA™ · ASGA™ · RIS™

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Governed Space

Validation Object Relationship

Canonical Definition

Validation Object Relationship Module (VORM) defines the governance framework for identifying, classifying, evaluating, maintaining, and documenting the material relationships and dependencies that may affect a Validation Object or the applicability of its validation.

It establishes the conditions under which relationships between the Validation Object and its components, parent objects, dependent objects, external systems, data sources, operational environments, human actors, services, infrastructure, and other relevant entities are made visible to validation governance.

Operational Role

VORM governs the relationship layer of Validation Object governance.

Its role is to ensure that a Validation Object is not treated as methodologically isolated when its validity, behavior, state, operation, or interpretation materially depends upon other entities or environmental conditions.

VORM establishes which relationships must remain visible throughout validation so that subsequent validation activities can distinguish

the object itself from the external conditions capable of influencing it.

Module Operational Space

VORM governs:

- object relationships,
 - object dependencies,
 - parent-child relationships,
 - component relationships,
 - upstream dependencies,
 - downstream dependencies,
 - external-system relationships,
 - data-source relationships,
 - infrastructure relationships,
 - human-system relationships,
 - environmental relationships,
 - relationship materiality,
 - relationship change,
 - dependency continuity,
 - and relationship traceability.
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Module Function

VORM applies wherever a Validation Object interacts with, depends upon, contains, is contained by, receives input from, provides output to, or is materially influenced by another entity.

Its function is to prevent:

- hidden validation dependencies,
 - treatment of dependent objects as independent,
 - omission of materially relevant relationships,
 - unsupported attribution of external failures to the Validation Object,
 - unsupported attribution of object validity to dependent systems,
 - loss of dependency visibility,
 - validation conclusions based on obsolete relationships,
 - and incorrect reliance after material relationship change.
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Relationship Classification

Material relationships may be classified according to their relevance to validation.

Where applicable, VORM may distinguish:

Structural Relationships

Relationships between the Validation Object and its internal

components, parent structures, subsystems, or composite elements.

Dependency Relationships

Relationships where the Validation Object depends upon another entity, resource, service, dataset, infrastructure component, or operational condition.

Input Relationships

Relationships through which information, data, instructions, resources, or other inputs enter the Validation Object.

Output Relationships Relationships through which the Validation Object produces information, decisions, actions, states, or other outputs affecting external entities.

Operational Relationships

Relationships arising through interaction with users, organizations, systems, environments, infrastructure, or operational processes.

Contextual Relationships

Relationships whose significance depends upon the context in which the Validation Object is used, interpreted, deployed, or relied upon.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Identify Material Relationships

Determine which entities, systems, components, sources, environments, actors, or dependencies have a relationship capable of materially affecting validation.

2. Classify Relationship Type

Determine the nature of each relevant relationship, including where applicable:

- structural,
- dependency,
- input,
- output,
- operational,
- contextual,
- hierarchical,
- or external relationships.

3. Determine Relationship Materiality

Assess whether the relationship can materially affect:

- object behavior,
- object state,
- validation criteria,
- evidence applicability,
- validation execution,
- validation determination,
- validation state,
- or permitted reliance.

4. Govern Relationship Change

Where a material relationship changes, determine whether that change:

- has no material validation effect,
- modifies assumptions,
- alters the Validation Object,
- changes validation applicability,
- restricts reliance,
- or creates a potential revalidation requirement.

5. Preserve Relationship Traceability

Maintain sufficient records to determine:

- which relationships existed during validation,
- which relationships were considered material,
- how those relationships affected the object,
- which dependencies were relied upon,
- when relationships changed,
- and whether those changes affected validation applicability.

Relationship Materiality Principle

Not every relationship surrounding a Validation Object requires governance at the same level.

VORM focuses on **material relationships** —relationships whose existence, absence, state, or change can reasonably affect the validity or applicability of validation.

This prevents validation governance from becoming unnecessarily expansive while ensuring that consequential dependencies remain visible.

Relationship Change Governance

A Validation Object may remain internally unchanged while its surrounding relationships change materially.

Examples include:

- replacement of an external data source,
- migration to different infrastructure,
- modification of an external API,
- change in human oversight,
- replacement of a dependent model,
- alteration of upstream data processing,
- deployment into a different operational environment,
- or removal of a previously available dependency.

VORM ensures that such changes are not ignored merely because the Validation Object itself has not been directly modified.

A material relationship change may therefore affect validation applicability without necessarily creating a new Validation Object.

Use Case 1 — AI System Dependencies

Scenario

An AI application relies on an external foundation model, retrieval database, cloud infrastructure, and third-party data feeds.

Application

VORM identifies and classifies the relationships between the Validation Object and each material dependency, determines their relevance to validation, and records the dependency conditions existing during validation.

Result

The validation determination remains interpretable in relation to the ecosystem within which the AI application was actually validated.

Use Case 2 — Automated Decision Environment

Scenario

An automated decision system remains technically unchanged, but the external dataset supplying its primary input is replaced.

Application

VORM recognizes the data-source relationship as materially relevant and evaluates whether the relationship change affects the applicability of the existing validation.

Result

The organization does not assume that unchanged software automatically means unchanged validation conditions.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Object Relationship Module establishes the canonical governance framework for making material relationships and dependencies visible within Validation Object governance. By governing relationship identification, classification, materiality, change, continuity, and traceability, VORM ensures that validation determinations remain interpretable within the actual relational environment in which the Validation Object exists, operates, and is relied upon.

Parent Resources

[→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Internal Module Flow

[→ Previous module: Validation Object Version Module \(VOVM\)](#)

[→ Next module: Validation Object Fitness Module \(VOFM\)](#)

Related Documents

[→ Validation Object Standard](#)

[→ About Validation Object Standard](#)

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Canonical Source

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